AI FOR MANAGERS · STUDY GUIDE

Develop — Moving Each Person Forward

How do I help each person take the right next step in their development?

MODULE 5 · LESSON 3 | LEAD: CAPABILITY | Action lesson · 10–12 min

THE CORE IDEA

Development improves when you read where each person is, agree one step that fits, and adjust together.

Positions are starting reads, not fixed labels — people move between them as they learn.

1 One team, four different places

Every person on your team is somewhere different with AI. One has been experimenting for months. Another does exactly what's expected — no more. A third is holding back. A fourth is genuinely trying, failing, and losing confidence. One shared team message can't address four different development needs. **Develop** is individual work: move each person forward from where they actually are — not at the same pace, in the same direction, or with the same response. The way in is the **Asking** lever from Reinforce: it surfaces what each person is trying, what's working, and where they've stalled.

2 The three-step Develop sequence

However different your people are, you move each one forward the same way, one person at a time, usually in a one-to-one: **Step 1 — Understand** where the person is with AI. **Step 2 — Agree a next step** — one concrete task that fits. **Step 3 — Follow up and adjust**.

3 Step 1: read where they are

You're not starting from zero — the **Team AI Baseline** from Assess gave you a first picture of each person. But that was a snapshot, and people move. The real read happens in conversation: when a one-to-one gets to AI, open with **"Walk me through how you've been using AI on your work recently."** Not *"are you using AI?"* — that gets a yes or no. Listen for four patterns:

Exploring
Ahead of the team, brings up examples unprompted, asking what's next.

Complying
Does it, but vague — no real examples, low energy.

Resisting
Hesitation, "it doesn't really fit my work," pauses.

Struggling
Tried it, it didn't work, confidence dropping.

These are starting guesses, not fixed labels. And someone who's simply doing well needs no pattern: name it, agree a step that keeps them going, move on.

4 Step 2: agree one step that fits

Help the person commit to at least one concrete step – specific and agreed, not a vague "use AI more." The step must fit where they are, because the same nudge that helps one person harms another. **Exploring**: stretch them and make their work visible – *"What have you figured out that the rest of the team doesn't know yet?"* **Complying**: connect AI to something they'd like to change – *"What part of your work do you wish took less time?"* **Resisting**: surface the concern first; pushing buries it – *"What's making this feel uncertain for you – specifically?"* **Struggling**: go smaller – one task they can win at – *"Where exactly does it break down for you?"*

Before you close, run the **three-part step test**: can you both say what they'll try, on what work, and when you'll talk about how it went? If not, it isn't a step yet. The full set – signals, questions, task ideas – is on the **Develop Reference Card**; glance at it before a one-to-one.

5 Step 3: follow up and adjust

Go back to the exact step and ask what they tried, what worked, and what they'd do differently. The answers tell you two things – how the person is doing, and whether your read was right. A step that doesn't land is **information, not failure**: recalibrate together. Follow up sooner when someone is blocked, losing confidence, or the work carries risk. And name what this is: coaching – a skill you already have, pointed at a new subject.

RUN THE SEQUENCE ONCE THIS WEEK

1. **Before:** pick one person and guess their position loosely – the Team AI Baseline gives a head start. Keep the Reference Card nearby.
2. **During:** open with the walk-me-through question, listen for the patterns, agree one step, set the check-back.
3. **After:** jot it into your **Lead AI Adoption Plan** – position, evidence, agreed step, follow-up date. The first row of your Develop entry.

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY AFTER THIS LESSON

- Meet each person where they actually are – retire the single team message as a development tool.
- Open the AI part of one-to-ones with *"walk me through…"*, not *"are you using AI?"*
- Hold every read loosely, and let follow-up evidence confirm or correct it.
- Close no conversation without the three-part step test passing.

Module 5 · Lead: Capability – the module that turns the standard into durable capability. Download with this lesson: **Handout A – Develop Reference Card**. **Next: Lesson 5.4 – Amplify – Building Collective Capability** – turning what one person learns into capability the whole team keeps.